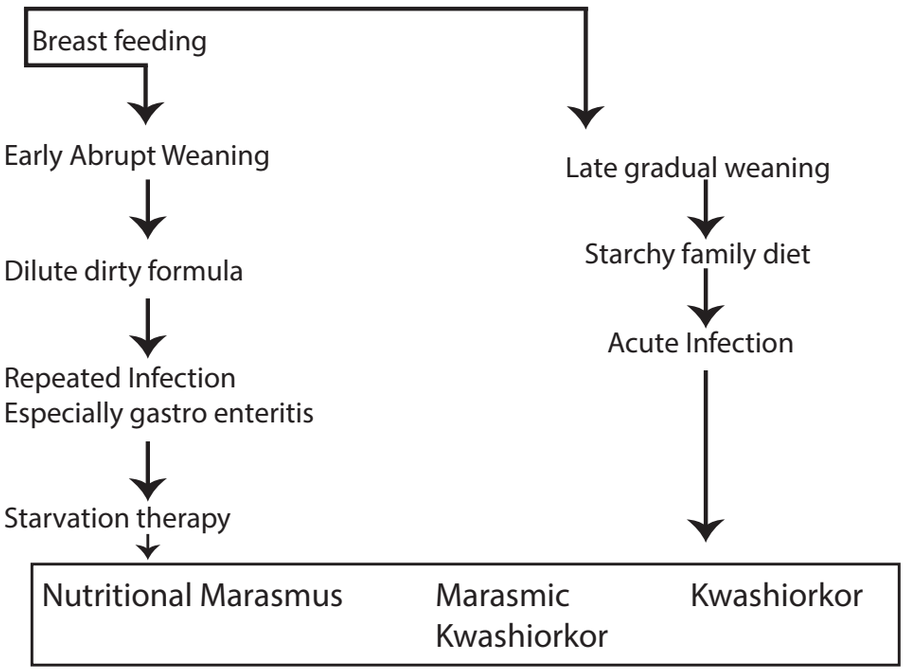


Fig 10.7: Causes of PEM

10.7.4 Clinical signs and symptoms of PEM

I. Kwashiorkor

This disease was first reported to occur in children in Africa by Dr.Cicely Williams in 1935.

It is caused by deficiency of proteins in the diet. The important symptoms of the disease are:

1) Growth failure
2) Oedema of the face and lower limbs
3) Muscle wasting
4) Fatty liver
5) Anorexia (loss of appetite)
6) Diarrhoea
7) Change in the colour, sparse, soft and thin hair.
8) Change in the colour of the skin (hypo and hyperpigmentation)
9) Anaemia
10) Vitamin A deficiency
11) Angular stomatitis (Cracks in the corners of mouth)
12) Cheilosis (inflammation and cracks in lips)
13) Moon face

II. Marasmus

This is caused by severe deficiency of proteins and calories in the diet. The important features are as follows:

1) Severe wasting of muscles
2) Loss of subcutaneous fat (Limbs appear as skin and bones)
3) Skin is dry and atrophic
4) Anaemia
5) Eye lesions due to Vitamin A deficiency
6) Irritability and fretfulness
7) Diarrhoea

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